



Europe



Rugged landscape

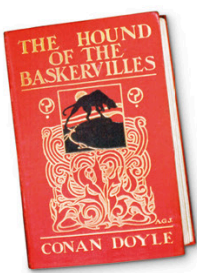
The UK countryside consists of green rolling hills, moors, and rocky coastline. Scotland is known for its rugged mountains and unspoiled wilderness, such as that on the Isle of Skye (above).

High-pitched pipes

Playing bagpipes in traditional dress is a custom in Scotland and Ireland. Bagpipes were once played on battlefields to scare enemy troops.

Sherlock Holmes

Scottish writer Arthur Conan Doyle (1859–1930) created the famous fictional detective Sherlock Holmes, hero of *The Hound of the Baskervilles* novel.



Angel of the North

Standing 65 ft (20 m) tall, this landmark steel sculpture by British artist Antony Gormley has dominated the skyline in northeast England since 1998.

Super city

The Thames River flows through London, one of the oldest major cities in the world and now a buzzing metropolis with nearly 9 million people.

The Shard is a 95-story skyscraper with panoramic views.



Geography: The highest mountains lie in Scotland and Wales, while the Pennines are known as the spine of England.



History: The UK was one of the first nations to grow its economy as a result of the Industrial Revolution in the 19th century.



Culture: Cricket, rugby, and soccer were first played in the UK. British literature, music, and theater are popular worldwide.



Natural wonders: These include the Lake District in England, Loch Ness in Scotland, and Mount Snowdon in Wales.